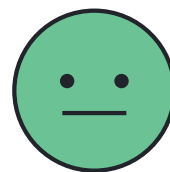
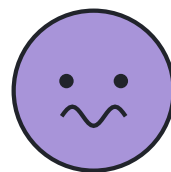
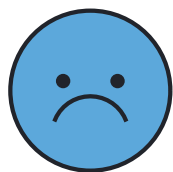


CALM & CONFIDENT SEL SERIES



I Can Wait!

A Patience & Waiting Skills Activity Pack - Handling the Hard
Feeling of Waiting

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 5-17 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

Welcome! This book helps kids and teens understand big feelings and learn calm, kind ways to handle them. Feelings are not good or bad - they are messengers. This book builds the skills to listen to them and choose what to do next.

Every page is printable and reproducible for your home or classroom. Go at the reader's pace, and celebrate effort more than 'right answers.'

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Do the activities alongside the child when you can - your calm helps them feel safe.
- ☐ Name feelings out loud together; naming a feeling helps shrink it.
- ☐ Never punish a feeling. Coach the choice that comes after it.
- ☐ Revisit favorite pages often - skills grow with practice, not one-time reading.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



Grows With the Reader (Ages 5-17)

This book is built for a wide range of ages. Younger children can color, trace, and point to feelings faces. Older kids and teens can use the same pages for journaling, deeper reflection, and building real coping plans.

Younger (about 5-9)

- ☐ Color the feelings faces and calm-down pictures.
- ☐ Trace the calming words and short affirmations.
- ☐ Do the breathing shapes with a grown-up.

Older kids & teens (about 10-17)

- ☐ Write in the journal and reflection spaces.
- ☐ Work through the 'What would you do?' scenarios.
- ☐ Build and personalize your own coping toolkit and calm-down plan.

What's Inside



- 1 Why Waiting Is Hard
- 2 Feelings While Waiting
- 3 Waiting Tools
- 4 Making Calm Choices
- 5 Calm & Reflect
- 6 My Waiting Plan
- 7 Gratitude



Part 1: Why Waiting Is Hard

Waiting brings big feelings too.

Waiting Is a Skill



Waiting is hard for everyone - our brains like things NOW! But waiting is a skill we can grow, just like a muscle. When we practice waiting, big feelings like frustration and boredom get easier to handle.

What waiting can feel like

Waiting can feel boring, wiggly, frustrating, or even worried. All of those are okay. The trick is having something to DO with your body and mind while you wait.

Feelings While I Wait



Color each face. Say the feeling out loud!



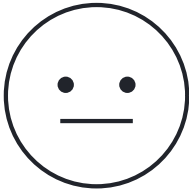
Impatient



Frustrated



Bored



Patient



Hopeful



Excited



My Impatience Thermometer

A feelings thermometer shows how BIG a feeling is. Green is calm and okay. Yellow is starting to bubble. Red is a very big feeling. Knowing our level helps us pick the right calm-down tool.



RED - Big feeling

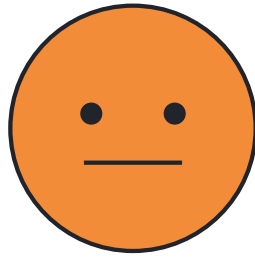


YELLOW - Getting bigger



GREEN - Calm & okay

What can I do at each level? Write above.



Part 2: Waiting Tools

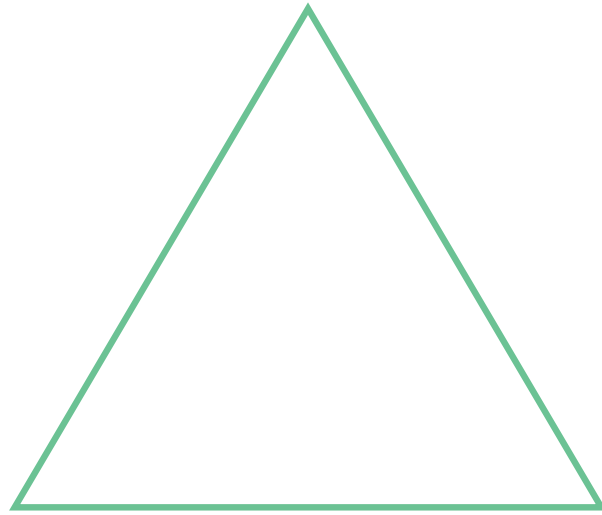
Fill the wait with calm.



Triangle Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Triangle Breathing



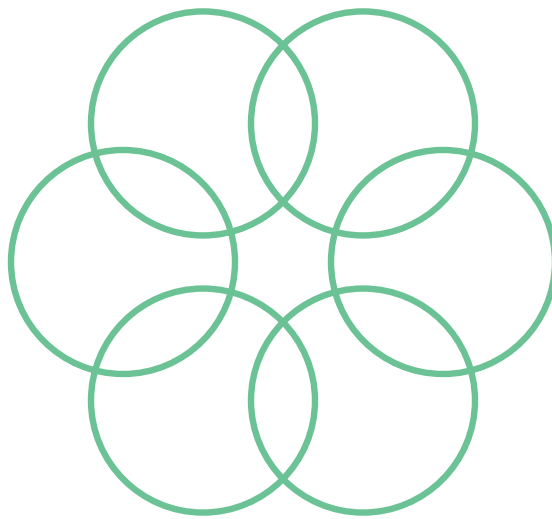
1. Breathe IN as you trace the first side (count 3).
2. HOLD as you trace the second side (count 3).
3. Breathe OUT as you trace the last side (count 3).
4. Go around the triangle slowly 4 times.



Flower & Candle Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Flower Breathing



1. Pretend to smell a flower - breathe IN through your nose.
2. Pretend to cool soup or blow a candle - breathe OUT slowly through your mouth.
3. Trace each petal as you breathe.
4. Notice your shoulders drop as you relax.



Waiting Tools

These are calm-down tools. Try each one. Circle the ones that work best for YOU, then cut them out or copy them for your calm corner.

1 Count or Sing

Count slowly or hum a song in your head.

2 Fidget Quietly

Wiggle fingers or toes, squeeze your hands.

3 Look Around

Notice colors, shapes, or patterns nearby.

4 Imagine

Picture something fun in your mind.

5 Ask How Long

Ask when your turn will come.

6 Deep Breaths

Breathe slowly until it's time.

Patience Words



Trace the calming words. Then say them out loud.

I can wait.

My turn will come.

Waiting gets easier.

Now write your own calming words:



First / Then Planning

Waiting is easier when we know what comes next. Fill in 'First I wait for..., then I get to...' to help your brain relax.

First I wait for:

Then I get to:

First I wait for:

Then I get to:

First I wait for:

Then I get to:

First I wait for:

Then I get to:



Part 3: Making Calm Choices

Feelings happen to us - choices are up to us.



What Would You Do? (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 You're waiting for your turn on the swings.

What could you do?

2 Dinner isn't ready yet and you're hungry.

What could you do?

3 You have to wait in a long line.

What could you do?



What Would You Do? (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1** You're waiting for test results or a reply to a message.

What could you do?

- 2** You want something now but have to save up for it.

What could you do?

- 3** You're stuck waiting during a long, boring trip.

What could you do?



My Calm Choice Checklist

Before I react, I can check this list. Tick the ones you want to remember.

- ☐ I take a breath before I speak or act.
- ☐ I name what I'm feeling.
- ☐ I ask myself: will this help or hurt?
- ☐ I use a calm-down tool if the feeling is big.
- ☐ I ask for help if I need it.
- ☐ I try again - mistakes are okay.

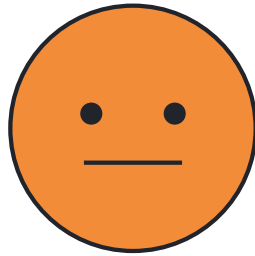


A Time I Made a Calm Choice

- Describe a time you handled a big feeling well.

- What did you do? How did it turn out?

- What will you try next time?



Part 4: Calm & Reflect

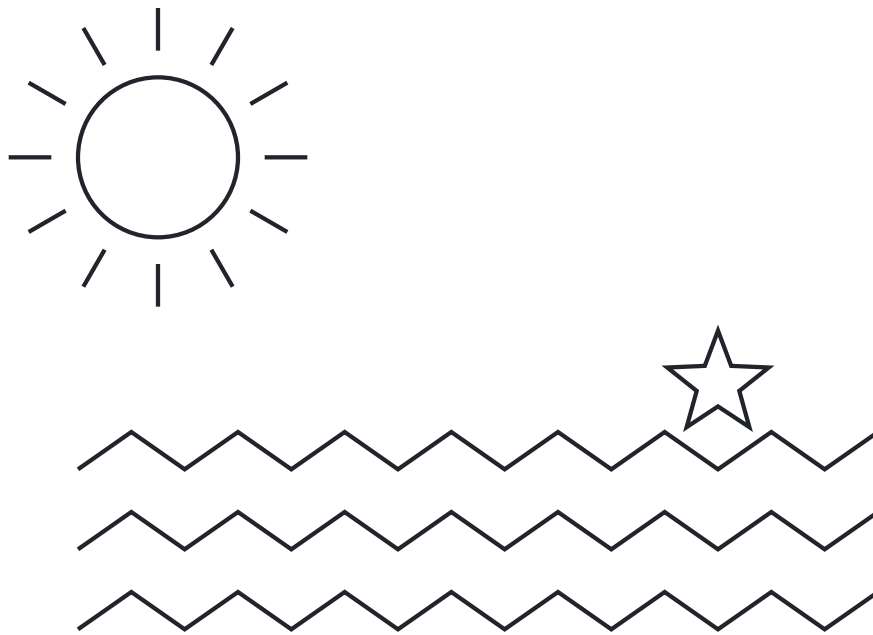
Rest your mind and notice the good.

COLOR

Calm Beach



A quiet place by the gentle sea



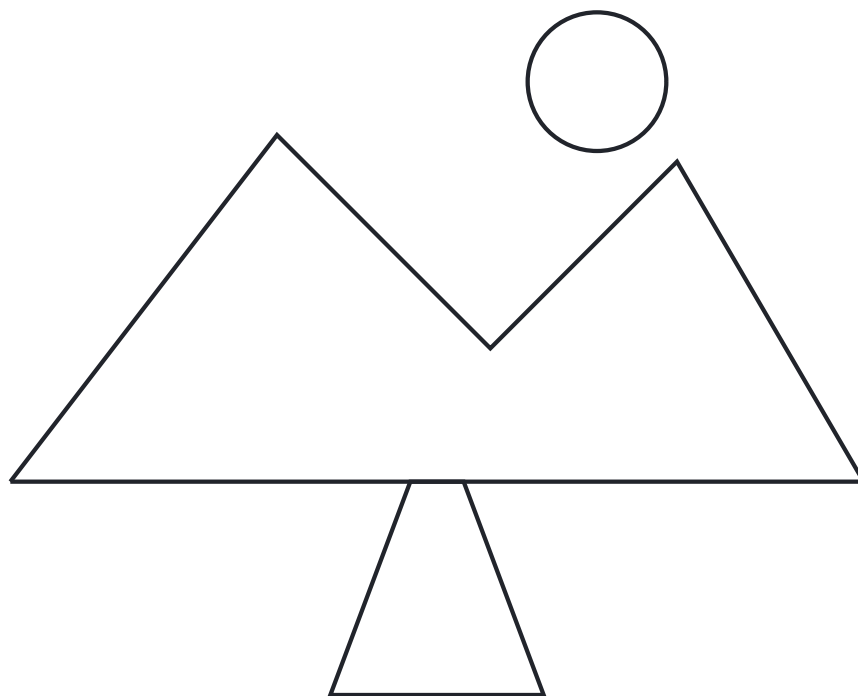
Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

Peaceful Mountains



Breathe in the fresh mountain air



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

Cozy Corner



A safe, comfy place to rest



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

My Calm Place



- Describe or draw a place where you feel calm.

- What do you see, hear, and feel there?

Draw your calm place:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for drawing a calm place.



Part 5: My Practice Week

Practice makes calm feel natural.



Monday & Tuesday

Monday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Tuesday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:



Wednesday & Thursday

Wednesday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Thursday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Friday & Weekend



Friday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Weekend



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

My Practice Week Review



● Which calm-down tool did I use the most?

● Which tool worked best for me?

● What do I want to keep practicing next week?



My Top Calm-Down Tools

Out of everything you tried, which tools help YOU most? Write your personal top tools so you remember them when a big feeling shows up.

1

2

3

4

5

When I feel calm, I can help others by...



How Far I've Come

Look how much you've learned! Tick everything you can do now (or are practicing).

- ☐ I can name my feelings.
- ☐ I can notice feelings in my body.
- ☐ I know my warning signs for big feelings.
- ☐ I have calm-down tools I can use.
- ☐ I can make calmer choices.
- ☐ I can ask for help when I need it.
- ☐ I can be kind to myself when things are hard.



My Personal Calm-Down Plan

This is YOUR plan for big feelings. Fill it in and keep it somewhere you'll see it. You can update it any time as you learn what helps.

When I notice a big feeling, my body signal is...

Three calm-down tools I will try first are...

A safe person I can talk to is...

Words I can say to myself are...

A calm place I can go is...



Good Things & Gratitude

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.



Letter to Myself

- Write a kind letter to yourself for a day you feel a big feeling.

- What do you want to remember?

- What would you tell a friend feeling the same way?

My Growing Skills



● One feeling I understand better now is...

● One thing I can do when it gets big is...

● I feel proud that I can...

Slowing Down My Mind



● When my mind feels busy, I can...

● A quiet thing I enjoy is...

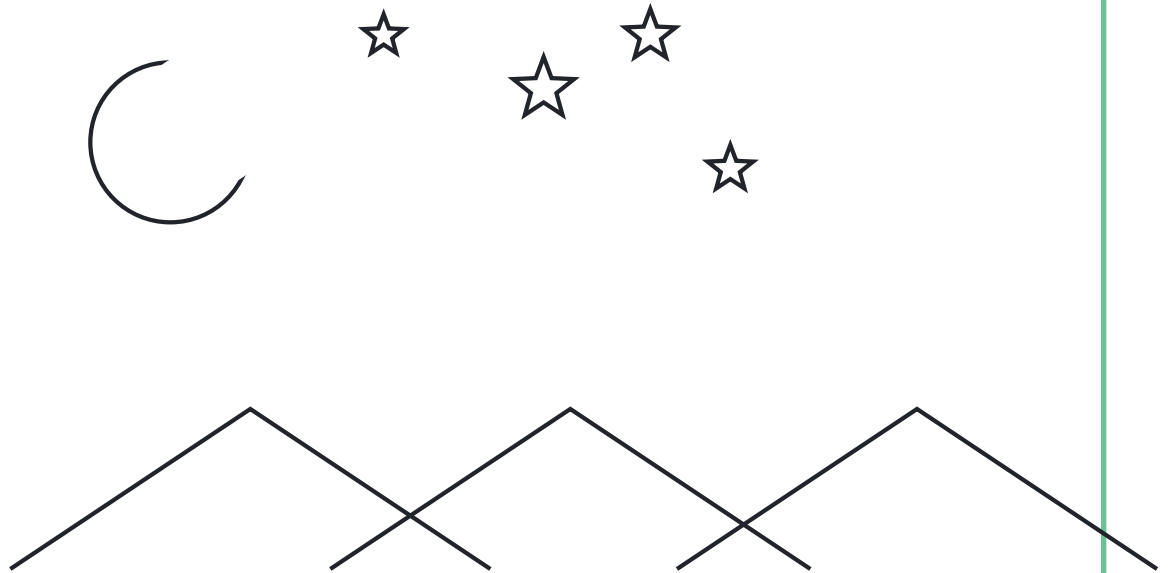
● One slow, calm thing I will do today is...

COLOR

Starry Night



A peaceful, starry sky to unwind under



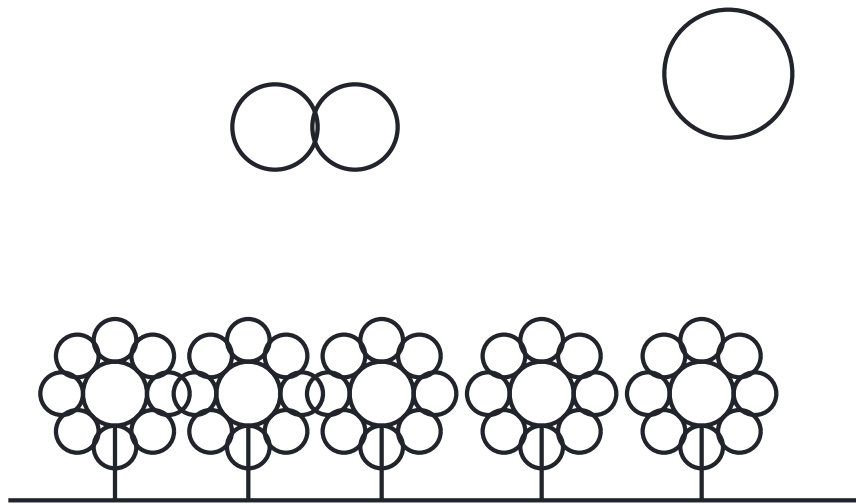
Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

Flower Garden



A calm garden bursting with flowers



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

Cozy Corner



A safe, comfy place to rest



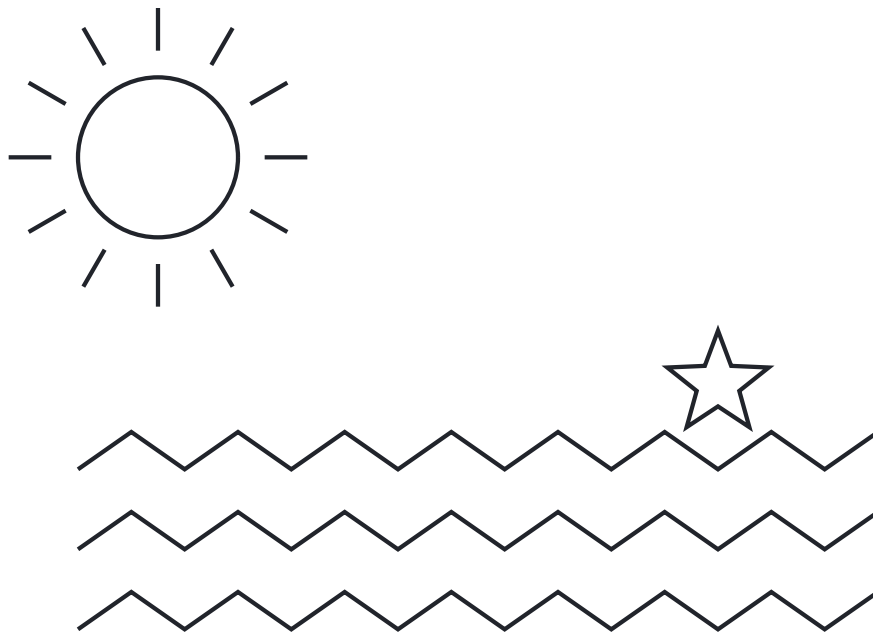
Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

Calm Beach



Gentle waves on a quiet shore



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

My Notes & Doodles



Lined area for notes and doodles.

My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, alternating between white and light gray backgrounds.

My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, alternating between light gray and white background colors.

My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, alternating between light gray and white backgrounds.

My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, alternating between light gray and white background colors.

My Notes & Doodles



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